

MOBILE SOFT PLC SIMULATOR

Deployment & Incorporation Checklist

Everything to do — from registering the company to shipping on the App Store, Google Play & the web

July 2026 | Prepared for Jarrod Franz | Working Checklist

 **HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST:** Each item has a ☐ box you can tick (click into the box in Word and type an "X", or print and check by hand). Items are grouped into phases in the order you should do them. The coloured tags under each item tell you Where to do it, the Cost, When to do it, and what it Needs done first. Work top-to-bottom — later phases depend on earlier ones.

 **DISCLAIMER:** This is a practical guide based on publicly available ASIC, ATO, Apple, Google and Microsoft information as at July 2026, not legal, tax or financial advice. App-store rules, government fees and grant programs change often — verify current requirements and fees before you rely on them, and consult a registered accountant (CPA/CA) for the tax and structuring items.

At a Glance: Setup Costs

A quick reference for the money you will spend getting from "idea" to "live on three platforms as a company." Amounts are approximate and in AUD unless noted; ASIC and IP Australia fees are indexed annually, so confirm the current figure at the point of payment.

Item	Cost	Frequency / Note
Director ID	Free	One-time, per director (ABRS)
Company registration (ASIC)	~\$600	One-time — indexed 1 July each year
ABN & company TFN	Free	One-time (ABR)
Business name (optional)	~\$44 / \$102	1 year / 3 years, if using a trading name
GST registration	Free	Required at \$75k turnover
D-U-N-S number	Free	One-time — allow up to 30 days
Trademark (IP Australia)	~\$250+ per class	One-time, strongly recommended
Apple Developer Program	~\$149 (US\$99)	Annual
Google Play Console	~\$38 (US\$25)	One-time
Code signing certificate	~\$120–300	Annual (for Windows .exe)
Stripe (direct web sales)	~1.75% + \$0.30	Per transaction (AU cards)
Business insurance	~\$500–1,500	Annual (PI + cyber)
Accountant (company + tax)	~\$2,000–4,000	Annual
ASIC annual review fee	~\$320	Annual

 Critical path: The D-U-N-S number gates BOTH app stores and can take up to 30 days. Apply for it the same week you register the company so it is ready when you set up your Apple and Google accounts.

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Incorporate the Company

Do this first — everything else depends on the company existing

☐ Apply for your Director ID

Every company director must have one before the company is registered. You apply personally with myGovID — it is quick and free.

Where: Australian Business Registry Services (abrs.gov.au) **Cost:** Free **When:** Step 1 — before anything else

☐ Choose and check your company name

Search the ASIC register to confirm the name is available and not too similar to an existing name or trademark. The name must end in "Pty Ltd". Also check the matching domain and social handles are free.

Where: ASIC Registers + IP Australia trademark search **Cost:** Free to check

☐ Decide share structure and officeholders

For a solo founder this is typically 100 ordinary shares at \$1 each, held by you, with you as sole director and secretary. At least one director must ordinarily reside in Australia.

Where: Your decision — record it for the application **Cost:** N/A

☐ Set a registered office and principal place of business

A physical Australian street address (not a PO Box) for official mail. Your home address is acceptable, or use your accountant's address for privacy.

Where: ASIC Form 201 details **Cost:** Free (or agent fee if using theirs)

☐ Register the company and get your ACN

Lodge ASIC Form 201, either directly with ASIC or (easier) through an online registration agent or your accountant. You receive your Australian Company Number, usually within 24 hours.

Where: ASIC or a registration agent **Cost:** ~\$600 (ASIC fee) **Needs:** Director ID, name, share structure

☐ Apply for the company ABN

Use your new ACN to get an Australian Business Number. Needed for invoicing, GST, and app-store tax forms.

Where: Australian Business Register (abr.gov.au) **Cost:** Free **Needs:** ACN

☐ Apply for the company TFN

A Tax File Number for the company (separate from your personal TFN). Usually offered in the same ABR application.

Where: Australian Business Register **Cost:** Free **Needs:** ACN

☐ Register a business/trading name (only if needed)

Only required if you trade under a name different from the company's registered name (e.g. "Mobile Soft PLC" vs "Franz Software Pty Ltd").

Where: ASIC Connect **Cost:** ~\$44 (1 yr) / \$102 (3 yr)

☐ Register for GST

Mandatory once turnover reaches \$75,000/year; you can register voluntarily earlier to claim GST credits on purchases. Note: Apple and Google remit GST on their store sales for you, but your gross store revenue still counts toward the threshold.

Where: ATO Business Portal / your accountant **Cost:** Free **When:** At/approaching \$75k turnover

☐ **Open a business bank account**

Keep company money completely separate from personal money — this is essential for a Pty Ltd. You will need the ACN and company documents.

Where: Your bank **Cost:** Usually free–low **Needs:** ACN, ABN

☐ **Set up accounting software**

Xero, MYOB or QuickBooks to track income, expenses, GST, and payroll. Critical for BAS lodgement and for substantiating the R&D Tax Incentive claim.

Where: Xero / MYOB / QuickBooks **Cost:** ~\$30–70/month

☐ **Engage an accountant**

A CPA/CA to handle the company tax return, BAS, and — importantly — the R&D Tax Incentive and grant claims. Pays for itself via the R&D offset alone.

Where: Local CPA/CA firm **Cost:** ~\$2,000–4,000/year

☐ **Get business insurance**

Professional Indemnity and Cyber cover are the key ones for a software business; Public Liability if you attend trade shows. Partners and education customers may require proof of cover.

Where: Business insurer / broker **Cost:** ~\$500–1,500/year

☐ **Decide how you pay yourself and set up payroll**

As a company you typically pay yourself a salary (register for PAYG withholding + Single Touch Payroll) and/or franked dividends. Avoid unrepaid director loans (Division 7A). Note: from 1 July 2026, super must reach your fund within 7 business days of each pay run (Payday Super).

Where: ATO (PAYG/STP) + your accountant **Cost:** Free to register **When:** Once earning income

☐ **Register the trademark**

Protect the app name and logo with IP Australia. Also strengthens your position for app-store name disputes and partnerships. File in the relevant class(es) for software.

Where: IP Australia (ipaustralia.gov.au) **Cost:** ~\$250+ per class

☐ **Write your Privacy Policy and Terms of Service**

Both app stores and your website require a publicly hosted Privacy Policy URL. Terms of Service / EULA covers licensing, subscriptions, and liability. Have a lawyer review, especially given the industrial-control context.

Where: Hosted on your website **Cost:** DIY or ~\$500–1,500 legal **When:** Before any store submission

☐ **Register for the R&D Tax Incentive**

Register eligible R&D activities with AusIndustry to claim the 43.5% refundable offset. Registration is due within 10 months of your income year-end — for FY2025–26 that means by 30 April 2027. Keep contemporaneous records of the novel development work (protocol engines, execution engine).

Where: AusIndustry (business.gov.au) **Cost:** Free to register **When:** By 30 Apr 2027 for FY25–26

☐ **Register for EMDG (when marketing internationally)**

The Export Market Development Grant reimburses eligible overseas marketing spend (App Store international sales count as exporting). Register with Austrade before incurring the spend you want to claim.

Where: Austrade (business.gov.au) **Cost:** Free to register **When:** Before overseas marketing spend

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Get Your D-U-N-S Number

The single credential that unlocks both app stores

Both Apple and Google require your company to have a D-U-N-S number — a free nine-digit business identifier from Dun & Bradstreet — to open an organization developer account. This is the most common cause of launch delays because it can take up to 30 days.

☐ Check whether your company already has a D-U-N-S number

Newly registered companies usually will not, but check first to avoid duplicates.

Where: Dun & Bradstreet lookup **Cost:** Free

☐ Request your D-U-N-S number

Apply free through Dun & Bradstreet (Apple also provides a direct request link). Make sure the legal entity name and address exactly match your ASIC company registration — mismatches cause rejections at both stores later.

Where: Dun & Bradstreet **Cost:** Free **When:** Same week you incorporate **Needs:** ACN + registered address

☐ Confirm your details are consistent everywhere

Your legal company name and address on the D-U-N-S record, ASIC, Apple, and Google must all match exactly.

Where: Cross-check all records **Cost:** N/A **Needs:** D-U-N-S issued

✓ While you wait for the D-U-N-S number (up to 30 days), work through Phase 1 and prepare all your store assets (icons, screenshots, descriptions) in Phase 3–5 so you can move fast once it arrives.

Account & Agreements

☐ Create an Apple Account with two-factor authentication

Use a company email address on your own domain (Apple requires this for organizations, not a free Gmail).

Where: appleid.apple.com **Cost:** Free **Needs:** Company domain + email

☐ Enroll in the Apple Developer Program as an Organization

Enroll on the web (organization enrolment cannot be done in-app). You need your D-U-N-S number, legal entity name, a working company website, a work email on your domain, and authority to bind the company. Apple may ask for notarized documents.

Where: developer.apple.com/programs/enroll **Cost:** ~\$149/yr (US\$99) **Needs:** D-U-N-S, website, company email

☐ Sign the agreements and enter banking + tax details

In App Store Connect, accept the Paid Apps Agreement and complete banking and tax forms (including the W-8BEN-E as a foreign entity) so you can receive revenue.

Where: App Store Connect → Agreements, Tax, and Banking **Cost:** Free **Needs:** Program enrolment approved

☐ Apply for the App Store Small Business Program

Reduces Apple's commission from 30% to 15% while your proceeds are under US\$1M/year — a large saving. Enrol as soon as you are eligible.

Where: App Store Connect **Cost:** Free (lowers commission)

Build the App Record

☐ Register your Bundle ID and create the app in App Store Connect

Use the existing bundle ID `com.jarrodfranz.softplcsimulator`. Create the app listing, choose primary category, and set up the app record.

Where: App Store Connect + Developer portal **Cost:** Free

☐ Configure subscriptions and in-app purchases

Set up the freemium tiers: free base, Pro Monthly (~\$12.99) and Pro Annual (~\$89.99). Create the subscription group, localized pricing, and a free trial/introductory offer if desired.

Where: App Store Connect → Subscriptions **Cost:** Free to configure

☐ Complete App Privacy details ("nutrition labels")

Declare what data the app collects. If the app is fully offline/local, this is straightforward but must still be filled in accurately.

Where: App Store Connect → App Privacy **Cost:** Free **Needs:** Privacy Policy URL

☐ Set age rating and export-compliance (encryption) answers

Complete the age-rating questionnaire. For export compliance, note the app uses standard encryption (e.g. TLS in OPC UA / MQTT) — declare it and confirm it qualifies for the standard exemption.

Where: App Store Connect **Cost:** Free

☐ Prepare store listing assets

App icon, iPhone + iPad screenshots at required sizes, description, keywords, support URL, and marketing URL.

Where: App Store Connect **Cost:** Free

Test & Submit

☐ Beta test via TestFlight

Upload a build and test with internal/external testers before public submission.

Where: App Store Connect → TestFlight **Cost:** Free

☐ Submit for App Review

Ensure the build meets the App Review Guidelines (functionality, subscriptions correctly implemented, no crashes).

Reviews typically take 1–3 days; be ready to respond to reviewer questions.

Where: App Store Connect **Cost:** Free **Needs:** All of the above

Account & Verification

☐ Create a Google Play Console developer account (Organization type)

Choose "Organization", not "Personal". You will link a Google Payments profile and provide your D-U-N-S number, legal name, address, contact details, and website.

Where: play.google.com/console **Cost:** ~\$38 (US\$25) one-time **Needs:** D-U-N-S number

☐ Verify your organization and identity

Upload official company registration documents (e.g. ASIC certificate of registration) and verify an authorized representative's ID. Details must match your D-U-N-S record. All contact info is confirmed via one-time codes.

Where: Play Console → verification **Cost:** Free **Needs:** Company documents, D-U-N-S

☐ Set up the merchant / payments profile

Required to sell subscriptions. Provide company bank and tax details so Google can pay out revenue.

Where: Play Console → Payments profile **Cost:** Free **Needs:** Business bank account

Build the App Record

☐ Create the app and set the package name

Create the app listing and register the package/application ID (mirror the iOS identity where possible).

Where: Play Console **Cost:** Free

☐ Enable Play App Signing and meet the target API level

Opt into Play App Signing and make sure the build targets Google's current required API level (Google raises this each year — verify the current minimum).

Where: Play Console → App integrity **Cost:** Free

☐ Configure subscriptions

Create the Pro Monthly and Pro Annual subscription products with pricing matching the iOS tiers, plus any free trial/intro offers.

Where: Play Console → Monetize → Subscriptions **Cost:** Free to configure

☐ Complete the Data Safety form

Declare data collection and handling. Must be accurate and consistent with your Privacy Policy.

Where: Play Console → Data safety **Cost:** Free **Needs:** Privacy Policy URL

☐ Complete the content rating questionnaire (IARC)

Answer the IARC questionnaire to receive age ratings for each region.

Where: Play Console → Content rating **Cost:** Free

☐ Prepare the store listing

App icon, feature graphic, phone + tablet screenshots, short and full descriptions, category, and contact details.

Where: Play Console → Main store listing **Cost:** Free

Test & Submit

☐ Run a testing track, then submit for review

Use internal/closed testing to validate, then promote to production and submit. Note: the 20-tester / 14-day closed-testing requirement applies to new personal accounts — organization accounts are generally exempt, but confirm current policy. First reviews for new accounts can take several days.

Where: Play Console → Testing / Production **Cost:** Free **Needs:** All of the above

Website & Storefront

☐ Secure your domain and build the marketing/landing site

A professional site is also an Apple enrolment requirement. Include: home/features, pricing, a download page, support/contact, and links to Privacy Policy and Terms.

Where: Domain registrar + host **Cost:** ~\$15–30/yr domain + hosting

☐ Set up Stripe for direct sales

Create a Stripe account under the company to sell the Windows perpetual licence (~\$129.99) and/or subscriptions directly, keeping ~97% versus the app stores' 85%.

Where: stripe.com **Cost:** ~1.75% + \$0.30 per AU transaction **Needs:** ABN, business bank account

☐ Build a licence-key / activation and delivery system

Generate licence keys on purchase, email the download + key automatically, and validate activation in the app.

Where: Your backend / a licensing service **Cost:** Varies

Packaging & Trust

☐ Obtain a code signing certificate

Unsigned Windows installers trigger scary SmartScreen warnings. Use an OV certificate (~\$150–300/yr, requires a hardware token/HSM as of 2023) or Azure Trusted Signing (~\$120/yr, no token, needs a verifiable 3+ year-old business — may not fit a brand-new company yet).

Where: DigiCert / SSL.com / Sectigo, or Azure **Cost:** ~\$120–300/yr **Needs:** Verifiable company identity

☐ Sign your installer and executable

Sign the .exe/installer (and ideally use an MSIX package). Note that SmartScreen reputation still builds over time per file — early downloaders may see a warning until reputation accrues.

Where: Your build pipeline **Cost:** Included above **Needs:** Certificate issued

☐ Build a proper installer

Package the Flutter Windows build into a signed installer (MSIX or Inno Setup/WiX .exe) with an uninstaller and update mechanism.

Where: Build tooling **Cost:** Free (open-source tooling)

☐ (Optional) Also list on the Microsoft Store

Listing on the Microsoft Store adds discoverability and handles trust/payments, at the cost of a commission. A one-time ~US\$19 developer registration applies.

Where: Microsoft Partner Center **Cost:** ~US\$19 one-time

Pre-Launch (all platforms)

- ☐ **Host Privacy Policy and Terms at stable public URLs**

Both stores and Stripe link to these. Make sure the URLs never break.
Where: Your website **Cost:** Free
- ☐ **Set up a support channel**

A support email and/or help page — required by the stores and expected by paying customers.
Where: Email + website **Cost:** Free
- ☐ **Add analytics and crash reporting**

Instrument the app (e.g. Firebase/Crashlytics or similar) to monitor stability and conversion across platforms.
Where: In the app **Cost:** Free tier available
- ☐ **Finalise consistent pricing across platforms**

Confirm the free/Pro tiers and the Windows perpetual price line up sensibly across Apple, Google and direct, accounting for the different commission rates.
Where: Your pricing decision **Cost:** N/A

Ongoing Compliance (recurring)

- ☐ **Lodge quarterly BAS and pay GST**

Once registered for GST, lodge Business Activity Statements each quarter.
Where: ATO / accountant **Cost:** Accountant fee **When:** Quarterly
- ☐ **Lodge the annual company tax return and claim R&D**

File the company return and lodge the R&D Tax Incentive schedule to receive the 43.5% offset.
Where: ATO / accountant **Cost:** Accountant fee **When:** Annually
- ☐ **Pay the ASIC annual review fee and keep details current**

ASIC issues an annual review notice on your registration anniversary; pay the fee and confirm company details.
Where: ASIC **Cost:** ~\$320/yr **When:** Annually
- ☐ **Renew the Apple Developer Program membership**

Apple membership must be renewed yearly or the app is removed from sale.
Where: App Store Connect **Cost:** ~\$149/yr **When:** Annually
- ☐ **Keep up with platform policy and API changes**

Google raises the required target API level yearly; Apple updates review guidelines and SDK requirements. Budget time each year to keep both builds compliant.
Where: Developer portals **Cost:** Dev time **When:** Ongoing
- ☐ **Meet super obligations on time (Payday Super)**

If paying yourself a salary, from 1 July 2026 super contributions must reach the fund within 7 business days of each pay run.
Where: Payroll / accountant **Cost:** Super amount **When:** Each pay run

✓ Suggested sequence: Phase 0 → Phase 2 (start D-U-N-S immediately) → Phase 1 while you wait → then Phases 3, 4 and 5 in parallel once the D-U-N-S arrives → Phase 6 to launch. The two things to start on Day One are the company registration and the D-U-N-S request.